

August 2026

Dear Jennifer,

I've worked in Lamorinda long enough to know that a fully remodeled mid-century home on a private .39-acre lot with heritage oaks and classic Orinda views doesn't come along very often - and 130 La Espiral caught my attention the moment it listed. The combination of soaring ceilings, a marble-faced fireplace, and those expansive decks overlooking the trees is the kind of setting that tends to stay with buyers well after they've left the showing. When I saw that the listing came off the market without a sale, I wanted to reach out.

Fifty-four days on the market tells me something worth paying attention to. It's not the home - the renovation quality here is genuinely strong, and the location near Orinda Country Club, BART, and Sleepy Hollow Elementary is exactly what qualified buyers in this price range are looking for. What the listing history suggests is a strategy gap: the visual and narrative case for a \$2,200,000 remodeled architectural home was never fully built. At \$860 per square foot, this home is priced right at the threshold where buyers expect to understand exactly what they're getting - and without the right media and framing, that question tends to go unanswered before they move on.

I've put together a focused analysis of what I think happened and what a relaunch would need to look different. It covers the three friction points I saw in the listing approach, a positioning comparison against the current Orinda market, and the specific strategy pillars I'd apply to this property. It's not a generic packet - it's built around this home.

If you're already working with an agent toward a new listing, please feel free to disregard this entirely - no hard feelings. If you're not, I'd genuinely welcome a conversation. No pressure, just a real discussion about what's possible.

With respect,



Ben Olsen

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The Path to Sold:

130 La Espiral

Orinda, CA 94563

4.0 Beds · 4 Baths · 2,559 Sq Ft · Orinda

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 130 La Espiral

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Fully Remodeled Orinda Mid-Century on .39 Acres - and a Listing That Didn't Show It

130 La Espiral has the ingredients that serious Orinda buyers are actively searching for: a top-to-bottom renovation with marble finishes and new hardwood floors, a floor plan that opens completely to the outdoors, four bedrooms across 2,559 square feet, and a private lot framed by heritage oaks with the kind of natural views that don't photograph by accident. The new roof, smart lighting system, hidden wine cellar, and a primary suite with its own deck are exactly the details that justify a premium price - and that buyers in this range expect to find when they're spending over two million dollars.

The listing ran 54 days before coming off the market without a sale. That outcome doesn't reflect the home's condition or its location in the Orinda Country Club corridor - both of which are genuinely competitive. What it reflects is a strategy that didn't build the visual and narrative case fast enough to convert the right buyer. At \$860 per square foot, the home sits at the entry point of Orinda's architectural tier, which means the marketing needed to make the architectural and lifestyle story unmistakable. When that story isn't told clearly, price-sensitive buyers hesitate and qualified buyers move on to listings that feel more certain.

\$2,200,000

List Price

\$860/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch for this home needs to do one thing above all else: give the right buyer the visual and narrative depth to understand exactly what \$2,200,000 buys here - the renovation quality, the setting, the indoor-outdoor flow - before they ever schedule a showing. That's the gap a stronger strategy closes.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: 54 Days Without a Pivot - Stale Listing Psychology Took Hold

Once 130 La Espiral passed the 45-day mark, buyer perception shifted in a predictable direction. Buyers who were still actively searching at the \$2,200,000 price point stopped asking whether the home was worth the number and started asking why it hadn't sold yet. That skepticism wasn't earned by the home - a fully remodeled mid-century on a private oak lot with heritage views is the kind of property that should generate early, serious attention. The listing simply ran out of runway before it found the buyer who understood what was in front of them. The right buyer was almost certainly out there. The strategy just never reached them before the clock expired.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork uses geo-targeted digital campaigns to actively find SF and East Bay buyers who are researching Lamorinda before they've identified a specific listing - putting this home in front of qualified decision-makers rather than waiting for them to find it through standard portal browsing.

Friction #2: The Visual Story of a Mid-Century Retreat Was Never Fully Told

A fully remodeled home with soaring ceilings, a dramatic marble-faced fireplace, expansive picture windows framing heritage oaks, and a primary suite with its own deck lives or dies on visual presentation. This is not a home that standard MLS photography does justice to - the architectural character, the natural setting, the indoor-outdoor flow between the main level and the expansive decks all require depth and context that flat, ground-level images can't deliver. At \$860 per square foot, buyers are comparing carefully, and the home that gives them the clearest picture of what they're walking into gets the showing. A listing that leaves the soaring ceilings, the views, and the deck sequence as an afterthought in the photography creates doubt where there should be confidence.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Sky Tour captures the lot position, the oak canopy, the deck setting, and the home's relationship to the Orinda hillside in a way that no ground photograph can - giving online buyers the spatial and environmental context that turns a click into a showing.

Friction #3: The Architectural Premium at \$860/sqft Was Never Justified in the Marketing

At \$860 per square foot, this home is priced right at the entry point of Orinda's architectural tier, where buyers are comparing it directly against other updated properties in the \$820 to \$910 range. That number is defensible - the renovation scope here is comprehensive, the lot is private and private lots of .39 acres with this kind of tree canopy are genuinely uncommon in Orinda, and the Orinda Country Club proximity adds real lifestyle value. But buyers at this price point are deliberate and well-researched. Without marketing that builds a clear, specific case for what distinguishes this home from a standard updated colonial down the street, price-conscious buyers conclude the number is aggressive rather than earned. The value was there. The argument for it wasn't.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Zillow Showcase placement gives this home an enhanced listing page with expanded media, premium positioning, and narrative framing that arms buyers with the specific reasons the \$860-per-square-foot number reflects genuine value - before they compare it against anything else.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	130 La Espiral	Orinda Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$860/sqft	Orinda architectural tier: \$860–\$910/sqft
Lot / Setting	.39 acres, private, heritage oak canopy, hillside views	Typical Orinda lot: .25–.35 acres, standard landscaping
Architectural Character	Mid-century, soaring ceilings, marble fireplace, picture windows	Standard updated ranch or colonial, conventional ceiling heights
Premium Features	Full top-to-bottom remodel, new roof, smart lighting, hidden wine cellar, dual decks, primary suite with private deck	Partial updates, standard finishes, single-level outdoor access
HOA	None	None typical for standard Orinda residential

The verdict: At \$860/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$860-\$910/sqft, this home sits near the lower end of that range. At \$860 per square foot, 130 La Espiral sits at the low end of Orinda's architectural tier - a positioning that is supported by the renovation quality, the private lot, and the mid-century character, but only if buyers understand what they're getting before they compare it to alternatives. The marketing needed to make that case explicitly and visually from day one. A relaunch that leads with the setting, the renovation depth, and the indoor-outdoor flow gives the number a story buyers can believe.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Rebuild the Visual Case for the Oak Setting and Architectural Character

The soaring ceilings, marble fireplace, and private deck overlooking the heritage oak canopy are the heart of what makes 130 La Espiral worth \$2,200,000 - and none of that translates in standard MLS photography. A relaunch starts with a full media rebuild: cinematic interior photography that captures the ceiling height and the fireplace presence, and a Sky Tour that shows the lot position, the tree canopy, and the relationship of the decks to the natural setting. Buyers who can see the home before they drive out are far more likely to arrive ready to make a decision.

Pillar II - Tell the Renovation Story in Full Before Buyers Start Comparing

A top-to-bottom remodel with a new roof, smart lighting, wine cellar, and a fully updated kitchen and baths is not a commodity - but it reads like one when the listing description is the only tool doing the work. BrightWork's 3D Matterport tour lets buyers walk through this home from anywhere, on their own timeline, and experience the renovation quality and the floor plan flow before they've scheduled a single showing. That kind of pre-qualification means the buyers who do come through the door already understand the value. Fewer wasted showings, stronger offers, shorter time on market.

Pillar III - Find the Right Buyer Actively, Not Passively

The buyer for a remodeled mid-century retreat near Orinda Country Club and BART, priced at \$2.2 million, is not randomly browsing portal listings - they're researching Lamorinda deliberately, often from San Francisco or the East Bay, and they've already formed a shortlist before they've driven out to tour anything. BrightWork's off-market private buyer list at offmarket.brightworkrealty.com reaches Bay Area buyers who have opted in specifically to receive property alerts before homes go to public listing. Getting in front of that audience before the MLS clock starts is exactly the kind of reset a previously listed home needs.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

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